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Policy into Practice: Examining Teachers' Knowledge as a Predictor of Teachers' Attitude Towards Child Protection Classroom Integration

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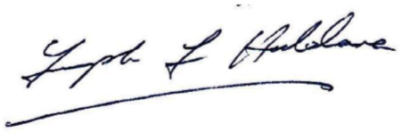
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Policy into Practice: Examining Teachers' Knowledge as a Predictor of Teachers' Attitude Towards Child Protection Classroom Integration

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The Department of Education issued DepEd Order no. 40 s.2012 or Child Protection Policy (CPP) to protect children and provide a safe learning environment (Casipe & Bete, 2023). Research indicates that teachers' awareness and positive attitudes towards CPP are important for effective implementation in schools (Bayucca, 2020; dela Fuente, 2021). Previous studies have examined the level of knowledge of teachers about CPP and the teachers' attitude towards CPP separately (Asio et al., 2020; Bayucca, 2020; Mag-atas & Carmona, 2023). However, there is a dearth of studies examining whether the teachers' knowledge of child protection policy predicts their attitude towards integrating child protection policy into their classroom practices.

This study aimed to examine the teachers' knowledge of child protection policy as a predictor of their attitude towards integrating the policy into their classroom practices. The study hypothesized that the higher the level of knowledge the teachers have about child protection policy, the better their attitude is towards integrating CPP into their classroom practices.

Method

Participants

This study has 159 teacher participants randomly selected through stratified sampling from the 3 chosen junior high schools of the District of San Mateo, Division of Rizal, Region 4A for the school year 2023-24. The schools that participated in the study are the largest in the district according to the number of teachers, with each having more than 70 teachers. The sample consists of 33.33% from School A, 32.08% from School B, and 34.59% from school C. The Cochran finite population correction formula was used to determine the appropriate sample size population.

Measures

Teachers' Knowledge of Child Protection Policy (CPP). To measure the teachers' knowledge of CPP into their classroom practices, participants were asked their level of knowledge on (a) the purpose of DepEd Order No. 40 s. 2012, (b) the different forms of child abuse and neglect according to the CPP, (c) the different signs of child abuse and neglect according to the CPP, (d) the reporting procedures for suspected cases of child abuse or neglect, (e) the roles and responsibilities of a teacher in CPP, (f) the prevention strategies for child abuse or neglect, (g) provide CPP-sensitive examples for the students, (h) the intervention strategies for child abuse or neglect, (i) the different ways to integrate CPP into my teaching principles, and (j) the provisions for ensuring the confidentiality and privacy of information related to child abuse cases. Items were rated on a 5-point scale, with 1 as *not knowledgeable,* 2 as *limited knowledge,* 3 as *moderate knowledge,* 4 as *knowledgeable,* and 5 as *highly knowledgeable.*

Teachers' Attitude Towards Integrating Child Protection Policy (CPP) into their Classroom Practices. To measure the teachers' attitude towards integrating of CPP into their classroom practices, participants were asked if (a) integrating CPP in their classroom is important, (b) they have confidence that integrating CPP into their lessons will contribute to its successful implementation, (c) the time and effort they use to integrate CPP into their lessons make them a better teacher, (d) integrating CPP into their classrooms will benefit their students, (e) the CPP is relevant to the subject/s that they teach, (f) the CPP inclusion improves the value of their lesson, (g) integrating CPP makes their lessons more relevant and engaging for their students, (h) integrating CPP into their lessons will create a safe and supportive learning environment, (i) integrating CPP in their lessons will develop necessary life skills in their students, and (j) integrating CPP in their lessons aligns with their values as a teacher. Items were rated on a 5-point scale, with 1 as strongly disagree, 2 as disagree, 3 as neutral, 4 as agree, and 5 as strongly agree.

Data Analysis

To test the hypothesis, the simple linear regression was used predicting the teachers' attitude towards integrating CPP into their classroom practices with their level of knowledge of CPP.

Results

A linear regression analysis was conducted to examine the relationship between teachers' knowledge of CPP and their attitude towards integrating CPP into their classroom practices. The Shapiro-Wilk test indicated that the data deviates from normality (W= <.001). However, given the large sample size (n=159), the central limit theorem applies. The q-plot showed approximate normality although some deviations are found in the tails. The

assumptions of normality using the linearity, homoscedasticity and Cook's distances were satisfied.

The overall model was significant, $F(1, 157) = 90.2$, $p < .001$, $R^2 = 0.365$. Knowledge of CPP explained 36.5% of the variance in the attitude towards integrating CPP into classroom practices. The unstandardized regression coefficient for knowledge was $B = 0.576$, $SE = 0.0606$, $t = 9.50$, $p < .001$, indicating that for every unit increase in knowledge, the attitude increases by 0.576 points. The standardized regression coefficient was $\beta = 0.604$, suggesting a positive and strong effect size. These findings suggest that higher level of knowledge about CPP is associated with better attitude towards integrating CPP into classroom practices.

Discussion

This work highlights that the teachers' knowledge of CPP is a significant predictor of attitude towards integrating CPP into their classroom practices. As a predictor, the study showed that knowledge of CPP explains a substantial portion of the variance of teachers' attitudes towards its integration into their classrooms. This aligns with Asio et al. (2020) which found that teachers' knowledge of CPP significantly improved their attitudes toward reporting suspected child abuse.

School policy makers must draft seminar workshops that emphasize CPP knowledge and its applications to encourage practical integrations in classroom practices. Strengthened knowledge-based interventions leads to better policy adherence which ultimately leads to safe learning environments for students. Other factors that influence teachers' attitudes

toward CPP integration must be studied to gain a more comprehensive understanding of the factors that builds teachers' attitudes toward CPP integration in classrooms.

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